

Speech by Prime Minister Narendra Modi

Event: 78th Independence Day Address | Date: August 15, 2024 | Location: Red Fort, New Delhi

1. Introduction and Salutations

My dear 140 crore family members,

Today, the world's largest democracy is celebrating the grand festival of independence. On this sacred day, from the historic ramparts of the Red Fort, I extend my warmest greetings to all citizens of India, both here in the country and spread across every corner of the globe.

This day is an occasion to bow down in reverence to the countless brave souls—the freedom fighters, revolutionaries, and martyrs—who sacrificed their youth, their comfort, and their lives so that we could breathe the free air of an independent India. We owe an eternal debt of gratitude to Mahatma Gandhi, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, Bhagat Singh, Chandrashekhar Azad, B.R. Ambedkar, Veer Savarkar, and millions of unnamed heroes of our national movement.

2. Viksit Bharat @2047: Vision for a Developed Nation

My countrymen, we stand at a critical juncture in our nation's history. We are living in the 'Amrit Kaal'—the golden era leading up to 2047, the centenary of our nation's independence. Our resolve is clear: to transform India into a fully developed nation—'Viksit Bharat'—by the year 2047.

This is not merely a government slogan or political ambition; it is the collective resolve of 140 crore Indians. Millions of suggestions have poured in from all walks of life—from youth, farmers, women, entrepreneurs, and scholars—outlining their vision for Viksit Bharat. Their aspirations are our roadmap.

Key Pillars of Viksit Bharat 2047

- **Modern and Resilient Infrastructure:** Expanding connectivity across rural and urban landscapes.
- **Technological Leadership & Digital Transformation:** Harnessing AI, semiconductor production, and digital public goods.
- **Economic Empowerment:** Targeted growth for youth, women, farmers, and marginalized sections.
- **Energy Independence & Green Transition:** Accelerating solar, wind, and green hydrogen adoption.
- **Self-Reliance (Atmanirbhar Bharat):** Strengthening domestic defense and high-tech manufacturing.

3. Empowering Youth, Innovation and "Design in India"

Our biggest superpower is our demographic dividend. India possesses the youngest population in the world, with boundless energy, talent, and entrepreneurial spirit.

Through initiatives like Startup India, Digital India, and the National Education Policy, we have fostered an ecosystem where our youth are no longer just job-seekers, but job-creators. Today, India is home to the third-largest startup ecosystem globally, with young minds innovating across AI, space, biotechnology, fintech, and renewable energy.

"I call upon our youth and industries today: It is time to expand from 'Make in India' to 'Design in India' and 'Create in India'. Products manufactured and designed by Indian minds should set global standards of quality and reliability."

4. Women-Led Development (Nari Shakti)

True progress is impossible without the active participation and empowerment of our mothers, sisters, and daughters. Today, India is moving beyond woman empowerment to 'Women-Led Development'.

From the cockpit of fighter jets to space research at ISRO, from sports platforms globally to grass-root self-help groups (SHGs) in remote villages, Indian women are leading from the front. Through programs like 'Lakhpati Didi', millions of rural women are attaining financial independence and becoming a pillar of strength for local economies.

5. Self-Reliance & Economic Resilience (Atmanirbhar Bharat)

In recent years, the world has experienced global supply chain disruptions, wars, and economic uncertainties. Amidst these challenges, India has proven to be a beacon of economic stability and growth.

We have made significant strides in self-reliance:

1. **Defense Manufacturing:** India is now exporting defense equipment to over 80 nations.
2. **Semiconductors & Tech:** Establishing semiconductor fabrication plants locally to reduce import dependency.
3. **Renewable Energy:** Achieving ambitious solar, wind, and green hydrogen targets well ahead of scheduled deadlines.
4. **Agriculture:** Modernizing agricultural practices, supporting natural farming, and enhancing food processing networks.

6. Reforms, Performance, and Transformation

Our governance mantra remains firm: **"Reform, Perform, and Transform."**

We have dismantled hundreds of obsolete laws, streamlined regulatory frameworks, and accelerated administrative processes. Corruption and nepotism are being rooted out with zero tolerance. Bureaucracy is being made more accountable, transparent, and responsive through technology and digital public infrastructure (UPI, Aadhaar, DigiLocker).

Our goal is simple: *Ease of Living* for every citizen, and *Ease of Doing Business* for every entrepreneur and investor.

7. Conclusion & Call to Action

My dear citizens,

The path to 2047 requires dedication, hard work, and national unity ('Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat'). Let us commit ourselves to duty. Every small step taken by 140 crore people becomes a giant leap of 140 crore steps forward for the nation.

Let us march ahead with confidence, courage, and pride in our heritage while embracing modern scientific temper and progress.

Victory to Mother India! (Bharat Mata Ki Jai!)

Long Live Freedom! (Vande Mataram!)

Jai Hind!